



Your Maternity Leave HR Checklist

California Edition | Generic guide for CA employees
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✓ Before You Leave

- ☐ Request your Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) paperwork from HR (if your employer has 50+ employees and you have 1
- ☐ Get your employer parental leave policy in writing -- weeks, pay %, and how it coordinates with state benefits
- ☐ Check your pay stub for a "CA SDI" deduction to confirm you are enrolled in California State Disability Insurance (SDI)
- ☐ Ask HR how your employer leave coordinates with California State Disability Insurance (SDI) and Paid Family Leave (PFL) -- o
- ☐ Confirm your health insurance continues during leave and how premiums are paid
- ☐ Set up or confirm your Employment Development Department (EDD) direct deposit at edd.ca.gov
- ☐ Request Pregnancy Disability Leave (PDL) paperwork from HR -- protects your job from day 1 regardless of tenure

✓ File Your Claims

- ☐ File your SDI claim within 49 days of your first day of disability -- this deadline is firm
SDI covers pregnancy recovery: 6 weeks for vaginal birth, 8 weeks for C-section. Week 1 is unpaid (waiting period).
- ☐ File your PFL claim separately after SDI ends -- it does NOT auto-continue from SDI
PFL covers 8 weeks of bonding leave at the same rate as SDI. File at edd.ca.gov.
- ☐ Submit FMLA notice to your employer at least 30 days before leave if foreseeable
- ☐ Notify your employer of your leave start and expected return date in writing

? Questions to Ask HR

- ☐ What is my last day of full pay?
- ☐ Does my employer leave run at the same time as state benefits, or after they end?
- ☐ Will my health insurance, 401k, and other benefits continue during leave?
- ☐ What is the process if I need to extend my leave?
- ☐ Who is my point of contact while I am out?
- ☐ Do I need to use paid time off (PTO) or sick days during the SDI 7-day waiting period?
- ☐ How do I submit timesheets or stay connected during leave (if applicable)?

■ Key Dates to Track

- ☐ Leave start date: _____
- ☐ SDI waiting period ends (Day 8 of leave): _____
- ☐ SDI claim deadline (49 days from leave start): _____
- ☐ PFL starts (after SDI ends): _____
- ☐ PDL ends (up to 17.3 weeks from day 1): _____
- ☐ California Family Rights Act (CFRA) bonding leave starts (day after PDL ends): ____
- ☐ FMLA / CFRA end date (12 weeks from start): _____
- ☐ Return to work date: _____

■ Key Resources

- ☐ California SDI + PFL: edd.ca.gov/disability | 1-800-480-3287
- ☐ California PDL + CFRA: calcivilrights.ca.gov
- ☐ Federal FMLA: dol.gov/agencies/whd/fmla
- ☐ San Francisco Paid Parental Leave Ordinance (SF PPLO - SF workers only): sf.gov/paid-parental-leave-ordinance
- ☐ Your personalized leave plan: leavigation.com/plan

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